

Vantara Group

Prepared by	Professor Paul Dolan & Wellfounded team
Assessment period	February 2026
Report date	12 March 2026
Respondents	847 of 1,200 employees (71%)
Classification	Confidential - not for external distribution

"Happiness is about what you do and who you're with - not just what you think."

- Professor Paul Dolan, London School of Economics

Key findings at a glance

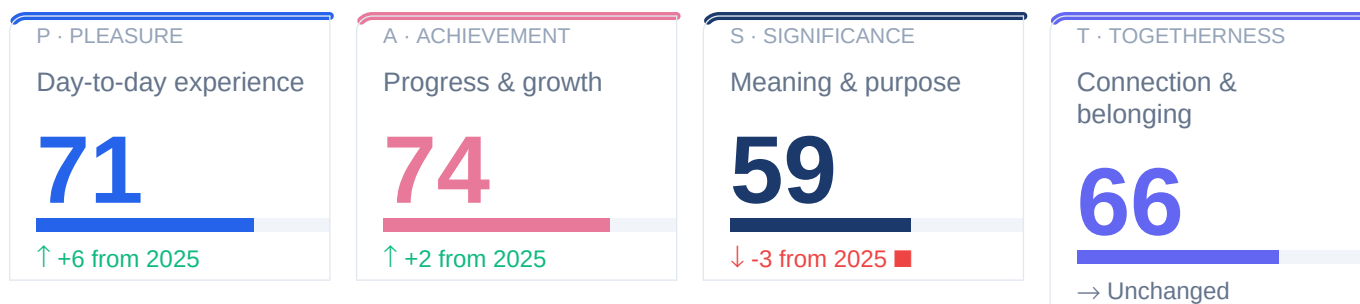


Vantara Group's 2026 Wellfounded assessment reveals a broadly positive picture with one clear area requiring urgent attention. Achievement and Pleasure scores are strong and improving. Significance - employees' sense of meaning and purpose at work - has declined for the second consecutive year and now sits below the sector average.

Achievement 74	Highest scoring dimension. Employees feel proud of their work and see growth opportunities.
Pleasure 71	Improving strongly (+6 pts). Attention and focus remain the key lever for further gains.
Significance 59 ↓	Below sector average. Declining trend. Finance team at 41 requires immediate intervention.
Togetherness 66	Stable but flat. Loneliness risk in hybrid teams not yet addressed systematically.

PAST framework results

The Wellfounded diagnostic measures four dimensions of wellbeing at work, based on Professor Dolan's PAST framework. Each dimension is scored 0-100, aggregated from individual 1-10 responses across 10 questions per dimension.



P - Pleasure: Day-to-day experience

A - Achievement: Progress & growth

S - Significance: Meaning & purpose

T - Togetherness: Connection & belonging

Pleasure scores measure the day-to-day emotional experience of work - enjoyment, focus, calm, and energy. Vantara's Pleasure score of 71 represents a significant improvement (+6 points) and reflects the positive impact of hybrid working improvements implemented in late 2025. The lowest-scoring question in this dimension was "I can focus on one task at a time without frequent interruption" (4.4/10), suggesting that attention fragmentation remains a material issue despite environmental improvements.

Achievement is Vantara's strongest dimension at 74, reflecting a workforce that feels proud of its work, sees genuine growth opportunities, and experiences appropriate challenge. The highest-scoring individual questions in the entire diagnostic were in this dimension. This is a genuine competitive advantage - employees who feel they are growing and producing quality work are significantly less likely to leave.

Significance - the felt sense that work is meaningful and matters - is the primary concern in this year's results. The 59 score sits 4 points below the sector average and has declined for two consecutive years. The Finance team's Significance score of 41 is the single most urgent finding in this report. The OECD guidelines on wellbeing measurement (Dolan et al., 2024) identify moment-level meaning as a distinct affective state - organisations need to create conditions where meaningfulness is felt in specific activities, not just communicated as an abstract value.

Togetherness measures the quality of human connection at work - belonging, psychological safety, manager relationships, and the distinct experience of loneliness. At 66, the score is stable but flat. The 2024 OECD working paper on affective wellbeing (co-authored by Professor Dolan) highlights loneliness as a rising and under-measured risk in workplace settings, distinct from social isolation. Vantara's result warrants closer monitoring as hybrid patterns solidify.

Score breakdown by team

Team	Overall	P	A	S	T	vs 2025	Risk
Strategy	78	80	82	74	76	+5	Low
Consulting	72	75	78	66	69	+2	Low
Technology	68	70	74	62	66	→ 0	Watch
Operations	61	63	68	52	61	-3	Elevated
Finance	54	58	62	41	55	-7	High ■

■ Finance team: urgent action required

Significance score of 41 in the Finance team (160 employees) is well below the 50-point intervention threshold. Two years of declining scores in this team, combined with a low survey response rate of 28%, suggest disengagement that requires immediate leadership attention. Wellfounded recommends a targeted half-day workshop focused on purpose, impact and meaning - with a follow-up re-assessment in Q3 2026.

Prioritised actions

The following recommendations are drawn from Professor Dolan's research on behavioural science and workplace wellbeing, and are tailored to Vantara's specific score profile.

1 Address Finance team Significance urgently

Significance · Finance · Urgent

A targeted half-day workshop with Paul Dolan's team, focused specifically on reconnecting Finance employees with the meaning and impact of their work. Concrete impact-mapping exercises have been shown to shift Significance scores by 10-15 points within one quarter. This is the single highest-priority action from this year's diagnostic.

→ £12,500 · Workshop + follow-up re-assessment

2 Run an attention audit across Operations

Pleasure · Operations

Operations Pleasure scores (63) are being held back by fragmented attention. A structured audit of meeting load, notification culture and protected focus time - followed by team-level commitments to protect 90-minute focus blocks - typically improves Pleasure scores by 6-8 points. This is low-cost and high-impact.

→ £3,500 · Facilitated audit session

3 Introduce purpose-led project framing org-wide

Significance · All teams

The lowest-scoring question across the diagnostic was "I feel my work makes a meaningful difference to others" (4.1/10). Implementing a simple practice of connecting project briefs to human outcomes - not just business KPIs - has measurable impact on Significance. This is a leadership and communication change, not a wellbeing programme.

→ Internal implementation · Wellfounded can provide toolkit

4 **Build social rituals for hybrid Technology teams**

Togetherness · Technology

Togetherness scores in Technology have been flat for two years despite improvements to hybrid working policy. Research (including the OECD 2024 working paper co-authored by Professor Dolan) shows loneliness is a distinct risk in hybrid environments, not resolved by flexibility alone. Small, deliberate social rituals - team lunches, peer check-ins, cross-functional coffees - have disproportionate impact on belonging.

→ [Internal implementation](#)

Sector comparison

Vantara Group scores are benchmarked against anonymised data from 142 professional services organisations assessed through Wellfounded. Benchmarks are updated annually.

Dimension	Vantara	Sector avg	vs sector	Bar comparison
Overall	68	64	+4	
Pleasure	71	65	+6	
Achievement	74	70	+4	
Significance	59	63	-4	
Togetherness	66	62	+4	

Professional services ranking (top 7)

1	McKinsey UK	81
2	Deloitte UK	76
3	PwC UK	73
4	★ Vantara Group	68
5	KPMG UK	66
6	EY UK	64
7	BCG London	61

Year-on-year performance

Year	Overall	Pleasure	Achievement	Significance	Together-ness	Change
2024	60	62	66	55	57	Baseline
2025	64	65	72	62	66	↑ +4
2026	68	71	74	59 ■	66	↑ +4
2027 target	75	76	78	70	72	+7 needed

Trend interpretation

Vantara Group has improved its overall Wellfounded score by 4 points in each of the last two years, demonstrating consistent positive momentum. The trajectory suggests the 2027 target of 75 is achievable - but only if the Significance dimension is actively addressed. Without intervention, declining Significance will offset gains in other dimensions and risk stalling overall progress.

How this report was produced

The PAST framework

The Wellfounded diagnostic is built on Professor Paul Dolan's PAST framework, which identifies four dimensions of wellbeing: Pleasure (day-to-day emotional experience), Achievement (sense of progress and growth), Significance (meaning and purpose), and Togetherness (connection and belonging). This framework is grounded in over two decades of wellbeing research at LSE.

Question design

The 2026 diagnostic comprises 40 questions across four dimensions (10 per dimension), designed to measure affective states rather than evaluative judgements. Question framing follows OECD guidelines on measuring affective wellbeing (Kudrna, Arachchige, Alidu & Dolan, 2024), using short recall periods ("this week" / "yesterday") to minimise recall bias. New questions in 2026 include loneliness (identified as a distinct and rising risk in the OECD paper), psychological pain, joy, and equanimity.

Scoring

Each question is answered on a 0-10 scale. Dimension scores are calculated as the mean of the 10 questions in that dimension, multiplied by 10 to produce a 0-100 scale. Overall scores are the unweighted mean of the four dimensions. Scores are calculated at individual level and aggregated to team and organisation level. Individual scores are never shared with the employer.

Confidentiality

Individual responses are stored pseudonymously and are never shared with Vantara Group or any third party. Team-level scores are only reported when a minimum of 5 employees in that team have responded. This threshold is communicated to employees at the start of the survey to ensure the confidentiality promise is credible.

Benchmarking

Benchmark data is drawn from 142 professional services organisations that have completed at least one Wellfounded diagnostic. All benchmark data is anonymised and aggregated. Benchmarks are updated annually.

NEXT STEPS

How to act on these findings

Recommended actions

1. Book a Finance team workshop with Paul Dolan's team (most urgent)
2. Share this report with your leadership team and HR Director
3. Schedule a 90-minute debrief with Paul Dolan to discuss findings
4. Set a date for the 2027 re-assessment (January recommended)

To book a session or discuss this report:

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